

notes

Taking notes in class...

Markdown → PDF (macOS)

This repo uses **md-to-pdf** (headless Chromium) plus **pdf-theme.css** so exports look clean on paper: system fonts, readable code blocks, and sensible margins.

Setup (once)

1. Install **Node.js** (LTS is fine), which includes **npm**.
2. In this folder:

```
npm install
```

Commands

Command	What it does
<code>npm run pdf -- path/to/note.md</code>	Writes <code>path/to/note.pdf</code> next to the Markdown file.
<code>npm run pdf -- a.md b.md</code>	Converts several files in one go.
<code>npm run pdf:watch -- path/to/note.md</code>	Rebuilds the PDF whenever that file changes (stop with Ctrl+C).

Examples:

```
npm run pdf -- README.md
npm run pdf -- ./lectures/week3.md
npm run pdf:watch -- ./lectures/week3.md
```

Styling the PDF

Edit **pdf-theme.css** at the project root. The script always applies that stylesheet on top of the HTML that **md-to-pdf** generates from your Markdown.

Use normal CSS aimed at **print**: `@page` margins, `body` typography, `pre / code`, `table`, `blockquote`, etc. After changes, run `npm run pdf -- your-file.md` again.

Markdown commands for styling

Below is a concise reference for what you can write in `.md` files. The converter uses **Marked** with GitHub-flavored Markdown–style features (tables, task lists, strikethrough, etc.).

Headings

```
# Largest title
## Section
### Subsection
#### Smaller heading
```

Use more `#` symbols for deeper levels (up to six levels with `#####`).

Emphasis

You write	Result
<code>**bold**</code> or <code>__bold__</code>	bold
<code>*italic*</code> or <code>_italic_</code>	<i>italic</i>
<code>***bold italic***</code>	<i>bold italic</i>
<code>~~strikethrough~~</code>	strikethrough (GFM)

Paragraphs and line breaks

- One blank line starts a new paragraph.
- End a line with **two spaces** before the newline, or use a **backslash** at end of line, for a soft line break inside a paragraph.

Lists

Bulleted:

```
- Item one
- Item two
  - Nested item
```

Numbered:

```
1. First
2. Second
  1. Nested step
```

Links and images

```
[Link text](https://example.com)
![Description of image](./figures/diagram.png)
```

Paths to images are resolved relative to the **Markdown file's folder**, which helps for lecture assets next to your notes.

Code

Inline: ``const x = 1``

Fenced block with optional language for highlighting:

```
```javascript
function hello(name) {
 return `Hello, ${name}`;
}
```
```

Blockquotes

```
> Important definition or quote.
> Multiple lines can continue with `>`.
```

Horizontal rule

```
---
```

(or `***` on its own line)

Tables (GFM)

```
Column A	Column B
foo	bar
baz	qux
```

Alignment: `|:---|` left, `|:---:|` center, `---:|` right.

Task lists (GFM)

- [] Todo item
- [x] Done item

Escaping

Prefix special characters with `\` when you want them literally, e.g. `\*not italic\*`.